

If the script fails to work and displays a blank page, then it indicates either the code is wrong, or the server does not support this function.

The basic features of PHP can be divided into three major sections:

- Escaping from HTML
- Instruction separation, and
- Comments

Escaping from HTML: Here, a file is analysed and simply parsed until a special tag is reached. The entire text is interpreted as PHP code.

Instruction separation: The instructions in PHP code are separated exactly the same way as in Perl or C. Each statement is terminated with a semicolon. In PHP, the closing tag suggests the end of a statement. The syntax is as follows:

```
<?php
    echo "This is used for testing";
?>
```

Comments: In PHP, C and C++ style comments are supported along with Unix shell like comments. The comment comes at the end of a line or in a PHP block of code.

Any PHP scripting block begins with `<?php` and ends with `?>`. PHP source code is flexible and can be placed anywhere in a document. Such source code can never be viewed by selecting the View Source option in the browser. The only thing that is apparent while running PHP is the output in HTML format that is created as the PHP scripts are executed on the server before actually sending the outcome to the browser.

You can also begin a scripting block with `<?>` and end with `?>`. This is just a shortened version. It is always advisable to use the standard form of `<?php` in place of the shortened form `<?>` as the former is clearer and generally supported.

As in an HTML file, PHP files also have HTML tags in addition to some PHP script code. Some important examples are given as